

Instructions: There are totally 1 problems. You must show all of your work to receive a credit for a correct answer. No graphical calculator is allowed in the quiz and exam.

Problem 1. (10 points) Let $f(x) = x^3 - 2x - 2$. The equation $f(x) = 0$ has one real solution. Approximate it by **Newton's method**.

(a) Write down the iterative formula of Newton's method for solving $f(x) = 0$.

$$f'(x) = 3x^2 - 2$$

The iterative formula is

$$\begin{aligned} x_{n+1} &= x_n - \frac{f(x_n)}{f'(x_n)} \\ &= x_n - \frac{x_n^3 - 2x_n - 2}{3x_n^2 - 2} \end{aligned}$$

(b) Let the initial approximation $x_1 = 2$. Compute x_2 , x_3 and x_4 by the above formula.

$$\begin{aligned} x_2 &= x_1 - \frac{x_1^3 - 2x_1 - 2}{3x_1^2 - 2} \\ &= 2 - \frac{2^3 - 2 \cdot 2 - 2}{3 \cdot 2^2 - 2} \\ &= 2 - \frac{2}{10} = \frac{9}{5} \\ x_3 &= \frac{9}{5} - \frac{\left(\frac{9}{5}\right)^3 - 2 \cdot \left(\frac{9}{5}\right) - 2}{3 \cdot \left(\frac{9}{5}\right)^2 - 2} \end{aligned}$$

$$\approx 1.76994819$$

$$x_4 \approx 1.76929266$$